



Matka Canyon

Located to the west of Skopje, this canyon is known for its many caves and medieval monasteries and the artificial Matka Lake.



- ☑ 9,928 sq miles (25,713 sq km)
- 👤 2.1 million
- ★ Skopje
- 🗨 Macedonian, other languages (+4)

North Macedonia became **independent** in **1991** when the former state of **Yugoslavia** split into new nations. The country's **mountainous walking trails** are as popular as its **unspoiled lakes**, such as **Lake Ohrid**.

North Macedonia



Europe



Lakeside theater

A legacy of the area's Roman past, this amphitheater on the shore of Lake Ohrid was built in about 200 BCE but only rediscovered in the 1980s. It is now a venue for shows and concerts.



Theth National Park

Stunning scenery, the Shala River, the Grunas Waterfall, and the village of Theth (left) attract hikers to this national park in the Albanian Alps.

Tirana is the biggest and busiest city in Albania.



- ☑ 11,100 sq miles (28,748 sq km)
- 👤 3.1 million
- ★ Tirana
- 🗨 Albanian, Greek

This **mountainous country** in the **southeast of Europe** is home to many **historic castles** in the dramatic **Albanian Alps** and along the **coast**. Its capital, **Tirana**, is known for its **brightly colored buildings**.

Albania



Star athlete

Luiza Gega made history when she won Albania's first gold medal in the 1,500 m race at the 2015 European Games.

